

Vega 1548

An Exposition and Defence of the Tridentine Decree on Justification, in Fifteen Books — selected passages

Andrés de Vega, O.F.M. — Venice, at the sign of Hope, 1548. Bk. I ch. V (fol. 4v–5r); bk. IX chs. IV, XXXIX, XLI, XLVI (fol. 144r–144v, 199v–200v, 206v, 211r, 216r–216v)

Translated 1:1 from the diplomatic transcription. Citation formulae and locus letters are left as printed; descriptive marginal rubrics are translated. Sic-notes follow the text.

BLOCK A — Lib. I, cap. V, *On the authority of the Synod of Trent*

PDF 72 = fol. 4v · PDF 73 = fol. 5r

{fol. 4v}

{head: ON THE AUTH. AND USEF. OF THE DECREE. / On the authority of the Synod of Trent. Chap. V.}

[...]

And point by point we can show that this Synod had all those things on account of which this holy Pontiff was thus disposed towards those four earlier ones. For this Synod was lawfully assembled in {marg. *What a lawful assembly in the Holy Spirit is d.17*} the Holy Spirit, because it was proclaimed and convoked by Apostolic authority for causes of the greatest weight. Which one thing is enough, and is what is required for a lawful assembly in the Holy Spirit, as is clear from many decrees of the holy Fathers. And it had as presidents, in the place of the Supreme Pontiff, not just anyone, but three Most Reverend Lord Cardinals, legates de {marg. *D*}

latere of the Apostolic See. For that only two of them presided over this session — men conspicuous to all for prudence, gravity, piety, and incredible gentleness — the cause was a certain long illness, which compelled that most illustrious Cardinal who had been reckoned third among them to withdraw from Trent: Reginald Pole, namely, who draws his origin from the stock of the kings of the English, an outstanding and indeed singular exemplar of all nobility and sanctity, a man plainly heavenly, and angelic rather than Anglic. {marg. *What an ecumenical Synod is.*} Nor was this a provincial Synod, like others which have been convoked by Apostolic authority and have had Legates of the Apostolic See as presidents, but a general and ecumenical one, because for causes pertaining to the whole Church bishops were convoked to it from the whole Christian world, wherever the Roman Pontiff is acknowledged to be the vicar of Christ and to have power over all the faithful of Christ. And by the diligence and favour of the most blessed Paul, third of this name, by the grace and providence of God supreme Pontiff, and by the care and solicitude of our most happy and most august Emperor, and of the other Christian kings and princes, it was brought about that we have seen at Trent prelates venerable for piety {marg. *The authority of the Synod of Trent.*} and wisdom out of Italy, Spain, France, Germany, England, Sicily, Naples, Sardinia, Ireland, Gothia, Sweden, Dalmatia, Crete, Greece, and out of the Fortunate Isles set beyond the world. To these things was added, that this sacrosanct Synod, by the kind concession of the same most blessed Paul, had the fullest autho-

{fol. 5r}

{head: *BOOK I. ON THE PROOEMIUM 5*}

-rity, that it might establish, at its own discretion, whatsoever should please it, both in the dogmas of faith, and in the reformation of the morals of the Church, and in those things which might seem necessary for the peace of the princes of the Christian people. Nor {marg. *Why there was not added in the title, I | that wor- | d "Eccle- | siam uelem | repræsen- | tans."*} was it for those causes which certain men malignly allege that that title was left out which the Council of Constance often uses, namely *representing the universal Church*; but rather on this account, that although certain prelates worthy of all honour, with holy earnestness and zeal, often demanded that title, and wished it to be prefixed to all the decrees of this Synod, nevertheless in the end it pleased the greater part of the Fathers rather to imitate the modesty of the ancient councils, which never used that title. And most prudently indeed did they so judge, because no such cause now arose as would demand such a title, of the kind there was in the time of the Council of Constance.

For at that time, for the settling of that great schism which then prevailed, it was most convenient to employ that title, so that those who bore themselves as supreme pontiffs, while acknowledging themselves inferior to the universal Church, might at the command of the Council, which represented her, humbly yield up their pontifical authority for the peace and tranquillity of that same Church. But now, since the Church of God rejoices in one — and that an undoubted — supreme Pontiff, there was no cause which should compel the use of a title of that sort, in no way necessary. But since this holy Synod has had the legates of the Supreme Pontiff, and bishops were convoked to it out of the whole world, and there were very many prelates in it out of the most diverse regions and na- {marg. B} -tions, no one ought to have even the least doubt but that it both represented the universal Church and enjoyed that most beneficent and infallible presence of the Holy Spirit which the other general Synods in the Church have always enjoyed. And with such care and diligence, over a space of seven months, was everything pertaining to this {marg. *The diligence applied in framing this decree.*} decree examined and weighed by all the Fathers of the Council, and by very many most distinguished doctors of Theology who came together to Trent for the sake of the Council, that it seems a sacrilege to doubt about any part of it.

[...]

In which matter all of them deserve many and great praises and thanks from the whole Christian world, but the chief of them, in my judgement, the most grave and likewise most religious Most Reverend Lord Cardinal of Santa Croce, upon whom the care of framing this decree chiefly lay. Who shall tell how great and how unremitting were the labours which he bore day and night for this cause? He urged all, he pressed all to devote diligent labour to this business. The opinions of all, the doubts of all, both privately and publicly, he heard with a most gentle and untiring mind. He himself, according to his singular judgement and wisdom, corrected many things, changed many things, and varied the decree now into this form, now into that, until he should bring it to that perfection which he did bring it to, so that it should please all the Fathers. **I speak these things as an eyewitness**, and I say nothing of the very many private gatherings of chosen men. They were gathered together publicly into one, and each was asked his opinion upon everything — now the Fathers of the Council alone, now the Theologians in the presence of the Fathers — more times, I think, than

(the page ends here, mid-sentence; the sentence continues on fol. 5v = PDF 74, not transcribed)

BLOCK B — Lib. IX, cap. IV, *On the distinction of human faith from doubt and opinion, and on its various grades*

PDF 352 = fol. 144v (with the opening clause and the grade-rubric from PDF 351 = fol. 144r)

{fol. 144r} — (PDF 351; given only for the rubric and the opening of the grade)

[...] Wherefore it would perhaps not be improbable to maintain that some certitude of human faith too is utterly infallible. The second place among {marg. *The 2nd grade of human faith.*} human credibles is held by those things which, although they rest not upon the common authority of all men but upon that of one or of a few, are nevertheless everywhere held by all, whether in themselves or in things of their kind, with so great and firm a consent, as certain, that they would think it stupid

{fol. 144v}

{head: *ON THE UNCERTAINTY OF GRACE.*}

and foolish to doubt them. Such are: that bishops, when they ordain {marg. *C*} ministers of the altar, and priests, when they consecrate the most holy Eucharist, when they Baptize, when they absolve, or administer any other sacrament, have the intention of ordaining, of baptizing, of consecrating, of absolving, and of doing what the Church intends. For although the fact that this or that man duly performs his ministry rests upon the authority of one or of a few, nevertheless these things are everywhere so received, without any ambiguity, and the reason of human life together so demands that such things be held, that it is fair and just that all the faithful — unless some peculiar and vehement cause of doubting about them should arise — should give to them all a certain and in no way doubtful faith. For it is not likely that bishops or priests should wish to mock the faithful in so great a matter, especially since no advantage can come to them thence, but rather many detriments and damages. **And indeed the peace of consciences cannot stand, nor the sweetness and tranquillity of Christian life together, unless these things are**

held as certain and undoubted. Whence most prudently {marg. *Innoc. 3*} Innocent III, in the chapter *Veniens de præsbytero non baptizato*, writes thus. Of him who is born of Christian parents, and has lived faithfully among Christians, **it is so strongly presumed** that he was baptized, that this presumption is to be held for certitude, until perhaps by most evident {marg. *The 3rd grade of human faith.*} arguments the contrary should be proved.

(the third grade begins at this point: “*Eodemque modo licet non æquali iure, aut ratione, cum multa accipimus beneficia ab aliquo...*” — i.e. “And in the same way, though not by equal right or reason, when we receive many benefits from someone...” — not part of Block B.)

[...]

BLOCK C — Lib. IX, cap. XXXIX

PDF 462 = fol. 199v · PDF 463 = fol. 200r · PDF 464 = fol. 200v

(rendered continuously and in full, including every printed marginal)

{fol. 199v}

{head: *ON THE UNCERTAINTY OF GRACE.*}

-re impious. God receives all who flee to Him. And no one flees to Him better or {marg. *C*} more truly than he who does what is in him, that he may obtain His grace, and who truly loves Him, and grieves seriously and from his heart for all the offences committed against Him. And lest anyone should think thus of the most humane and most kindly Lord of all, He said openly in Deuteronomy: And when thou shalt see- {marg. *Deut.4.e*} -k the Lord thy God, thou shalt find him: yet so, if thou seek him with all thy heart, and all the affliction of thy soul. And through Solomon: I love them {marg. *Prou.8.*} that love me. And often through the prophets: Turn ye to me, and I will turn {marg. *Ioan.14*} to you. And more openly in the Gospel: If any man love me, he shall be loved of my Father. But these things are enough for the present. For other matters, which can more fully refute this great and intolerable {marg. *Reply 2.*} error, it pleases me to defer to book 13. Others think they untie this argument by saying that faith does not extend itself to objects which {marg. *Refutation.*} lie in the contingency of fact, not yet approved by the Church. But this is not to untie the argument, but to render it stronger and more

perplexed, and, so to speak, more knotty. Was not faith in the prophets, before the approbation of the Church, extended to assenting to many contingent facts revealed to them by God? Can not anyone also by faith assent, and is he not bound to assent, that he is in grace, where God should reveal this to him? What need is there of the approbation of the Church, that we should assent to those things which we know to have been revealed by God? Do not sinners believe by faith that they are under the hatred of God and outside His grace, when they are conscious to themselves that they persevere in the affection of mortal sin? **Do not the Fathers in a general Council know by faith that it is a legitimate and general Council, before they define that** {marg. *D*} **proposition?** {marg. *Reply 3.*} Others have tried to dissolve this argument by saying that from one premise *de fide* and another evidently known, a conclusion *de fide* cannot be inferred. Which they proved also by this reasoning. The certitude of faith is, according to St Thomas and Scotus and others, greater than the certitude of evidence; and that not only, as a certain learned man interprets Thomas, in itself, but also as regards us and on the part of our intellect and affection. For we assent more certainly and more firmly to things revealed by God than to things experienced and demonstrated. Which indeed proceeds partly from the greater propensity of our affection, partly from the fuller help of God and the concurrence of infused faith. Since therefore a conclusion cannot be more certain than the premises from which it is inferred, a conclusion drawn from one premise believed and another evident will not be certain with the certitude of faith. And to this perhaps John Baconthorpe looked, when he said that that proposition, *I am in grace*, is to no one *de fide*, but can be certain with a certitude consequent upon faith. Nor does a certain learned man seem {marg. *The conclusion inferred from one premise believed and another evident is certain of faith.*} to have tended elsewhere, who said that a proposition which cannot be inferred from things revealed unless one natural premise is joined to them is to be reckoned not *de fide*, but rather a natural proposition. **But I myself could in no way be brought to this opinion; nor, however much I might wish it, could I doubt that it would be certain to me by faith that I am in grace, if indeed I could gather this from one premise believed and another evident to me.** And that this is so I urge thus. Firstly. There are many propositions {marg. *Argument 1.*} *de fide* which cannot otherwise be proved to be *de fide*, save because they follow evi-

{fol. 200r}

{head: BOOK IX. ON CHAP. IX. 200}

{marg. A} -dently from things believed, together with at least some proposition evident according to the natural light. And this can be shown in many propositions about God and about Christ, which are received by all the faithful on this ground as certain, and whose opposites are reckoned heretical — as is clear of these: *God is incorporeal. God is immaterial. God is of infinite power. Christ has a heart. Christ has phlegm. Christ, according to His body and according to His soul, and all things contained in them, is under either species of the sacrament of the Eucharist. Christ, without the substance of bread and of wine, is under the species of bread and of wine*, and the like. For propositions of this sort are not expressed in the Scriptures, but are evidently deduced from what is contained in them, at least together with one premise evident according to the natural light. Wherefore our Scotus in particular shows this proposition to be *de fide*, *The Father differs really from the Son*, because it is inferred from this naturally evident one, *Every begetter differs really from the begotten*, and from this one *de fide*, *The Father is begetting, and the Son is begotten*. **The same is clear of propositions which depend upon the definition of general Councils, or of the Pope. For all those presuppose these propositions. This Council is legitimately convened. This Pope is rightly and canonically elected. Which indeed are not revealed, but evidently known — and therefore afterwards also defined, and received as certain of faith by those who did not have evidence of their truth.** And the very propositions which are expressly and formally contained in the Scriptures seem, at least for the acquiring of faith in them, to require in us the certitude of that evident premise. The Church- {marg. B} -ch defines these to be the canonical scriptures, and receives them as such. For there is for the most part no other source whence it may be certainly established for us that they are the sacred scriptures, and that what is contained in them is indubitably to be believed as such, so that we may begin to give them such and so great a faith. Secondly. If Peter should baptize some {marg. Argument 2.} infant according to the form of the Church, it will be certain to him by faith that that infant is in grace. And this for no other reason, save that it follows evidently from this believed premise, *everyone baptized who does not place an obstacle to baptism is in grace*, and from this evident one, *This infant is baptized, and has not placed an obstacle*. Thirdly. {marg. Argument 3.} A proposition inferred from one premise believed and another evident is certain, and non-evident, and the assent to it is certain and non-evident. What then is wanting to it, to prevent its being reckoned to be *de fide*? Certain indeed it is, because it follows from certain premises. But non-evident it is, because the conclusion always follows the weaker part. And just as in certitude faith surpasses knowledge, and the certitude of knowledge, compared with the certitude of faith, is imperfect — and

therefore a conclusion inferred from one premise *de fide* and another evident is not so certain as the premise *de fide* — so in clarity evidence surpasses faith, and obscurity is an imperfection and a weakness of faith; and therefore it is necessary that a conclusion inferred from one evident premise and another *de fide* be non-evident. Fourthly. Whoever should per- {marg. *Argument 4*} -tinaciously doubt about a proposition evidently inferred from one premise believed and another evident **would be a heretic**. For one who doubts about a consequent which he knows to be evidently inferred from certain premises must needs doubt about one of them; and since he cannot doubt about the evident one, nor about the consequence, which is likewise evident to him, he would dou-

{fol. 200v}

{head: *ON THE UNCERTAINTY OF GRACE.*}

-bt about the one believed. **Therefore that proposition which is inferred from one premise believed and another evi-** {marg. *C*} {marg. *Resp.1. to argu.3.re- | spon.3*} **-dent is by all to be reckoned, and to be believed, of faith. Nor ought the argument made to the contrary move anyone.** For first, it is not necessary to concede that all assents *de fide* are equal in certitude. Since some are *de fide* only because they are inferred from others; and *that on account of which each thing is such, is itself more so*, as the rule of the *Posterior Analytics* has it. And when it is said that the assent of faith is more certain than any scientific assent whatever, or any evident one that is not supremely so, this can be limited to those assents of faith which do not depend upon scientific or evident propositions. For since a conclusion cannot be more certain than its premises, in so far as it depends upon them, it seems consistent that propositions which are *de fide* only because they are inferred from one premise *de fide* and another evident should not be more certain than that evident one, upon whose certitude their certitude depends. Next. By the very fact {marg. *Reply 2.*} that some proposition is recognized by us to follow evidently from one premise believed and another evident — since it is at once recognized to be *de fide*, and consequently to rest upon revelation and infallible truth — we shall assent to it more certainly, out of pious affection, than to the evident proposition. And the assent to it will receive, partly from our pious affection, partly from infused faith, some degrees of certitude beyond those which it would have from the certitude of the premises and of the consequence; and through these it will surpass the certitude of the evident proposition. **And so on this side nothing will be wanting to it, to prevent its being reckoned to be of faith.** And in this way all propositions, or assents, *de fide* could be maintained to

be equally certain, as we also seem to experience in ourselves. For it is not unfitting that a conclusion should be equally cer- {marg. *D*} -tain, or more certain, than the principles from which it is inferred, if from without, and from some source other than the premises, it has some degrees of certitude by which it equals or overcomes their certitude — as happens in the case proposed, on account of the concurrence of infused faith and of pious affection towards the assent of the conclusion. Someone will sa- {marg. *Rejoinder 1.*} -y: What is certain by faith does not depend upon a proposition beneath which the false can lie. But beneath the certitude of non-supreme evidence the false can lie. For non-supreme evidence differs from supreme in this, that no one can be deceived in assenting to things supremely evident, whereas deception can lie beneath assent to things evi- {marg. *Response*} -dent not supremely. But this objection proceeds from a wrong understanding of the difference which is between supreme and non-supreme evidence. For non-supreme evidence does not differ from supreme because through non-supreme evidence someone can be deceived. For it belongs to the very notion of any evidence whatever that through it no one can be deceived; nor is it possible that what is evident should be false. And whoever has evidence of some {marg. *Supreme evidence is other than non-supreme.*} truth is certain that he is not deceived in his assent to it. But non-supreme evidence differs from supreme, because supreme evidence is of propositions whose significates cannot be otherwise, and in the assent to which no one can be deceived. But non-supreme evidence is of propositions of such a kind as can be false, and in the assent to which one can be deceived, even when he thinks that he has evidence of them. But just as it is not unfitting that some propositions should be *de fide* which indeed in themselves can be

{catchword: *falsæ*,}

(the sentence is completed on fol. 201r = PDF 465: “*falsæ, sed non quatenus subsunt diuinæ reuelationi, ita neque incommodum ullum censeri debet...*” — i.e. “false, but not in so far as they lie under divine revelation, so neither ought anything to be reckoned a difficulty...”)

BLOCK D — Lib. IX, cap. XLI

D.1 — PDF 476 = fol. 206v

{fol. 206v}

{head: *ON THE UNCERTAINTY OF GRACE.*}

[...]

Wherefore, since those opinions have not been condemned by the Church, although the opposite ones are much more probable, there is no ground whence the certitude of faith concerning our grace could be gathered any more on account of {marg. *Reply 3*} the sacraments received than on account of our dispositions. And that we may undermine and enervate this whole argument at the root, I say finally that even if it were certain by faith that, together with the sacrament of Baptism or of Penance, a repentance for sins of whatever sort suffices for grace, with the purpose of keeping the commandments and the will to receive Baptism, still it does not follow that our grace can be certain to us by faith. For although it can be evidently established for anyone whether he has these things or not, **yet it can be certain to no one, by faith or evidently**, as we set forth in chapter 17, **that he is truly Baptized, or absolved. Because there is required, for the confecting of these sacraments and of all the others, the intention of doing what the Church does**, as has been most plainly defined in the Council of Florence, and in session 7 of this our council, canon 11, on the sacraments in general. But of that intention no one can be certain, without divine revelation, by

{catchword: *fidem*,}

(the sentence continues on fol. 207r = PDF 477: “*fidem...*”, i.e. “*faith...*”)

D.2 — PDF 485 = fol. 211r

{fol. 211r}

{head: *BOOK IX. ON CHAP. IX. 211*}

{marg. A} [Howe]ver lawfully a man may seem to have been ordained, if nevertheless it afterwards evidently appears that he was not baptized in the form of the Church, then, because he did not receive the baptismal character, he must be

baptized again, according to the definition of In- {marg. *Veniens de pres. non bapt.et.c.1*} -nocent III and of the council at Compiègne, and must be initiated afresh into all the orders, that he may be able to minister in the priesthood. Moreover. **However much** {marg. *Arg.7*} **a baptized man might believe and might wish to receive orders from a bishop who is commonly reputed such, if nevertheless, by some chance or by the malice of the bishop or of another, either the bishop himself were not a bishop, or he had not had any intention of ordaining him, and this were afterwards established for certain, he would beyond doubt have to be ordained again, in order to be a priest;** and, as the doctors of theology commonly teach, whatever some of the canonists may have held, neither would he have conse- {marg. *Inno. albritius sum. cōf. li.3. ti. 22. q. 8.*} -crated the Eucharist at that time, nor absolved anyone, inasmuch as he would truly have had no power fit for performing these things. But if {marg. *Ange. uerbo. Bap.7*} faith in the sacrament does not supply the place of the sacrament as regards the character and the presence of the body of Christ in the Eucharist, whence should we promise ourselves, even probably, that it supplies as regards the remission of guilt and of punishment? But thus far concerning certitude from the sacraments received.

{Immediately following, the chapter heading: “De incertitudine innocentiae. Cap. XLII.” — i.e. “On the uncertainty of innocence. Chap. XLII.” — end of cap. XLI.}

BLOCK E — Lib. IX, cap. XLVI

PDF 495 = fol. 216r (concluding word on PDF 496 = fol. 216v)

{fol. 216r}

{head: BOOK IX. ON CHAP. IX. 216}

[...]

(lead-in, for the sense:) Firstly. Arguments can present themselves as strong to persuade spiritual men of their own justification as are those which persuade of other things which all judge both can and ought {marg. *Argument 1.*} to be believed by us for certain, and without any fear. For we Christians, all of us sprung from Christian parents and brought up among Christians, believe for certain that we are baptized, nor have any but the rarest and most scrupulous even the least fear on that head. And the same we presume so firmly of any other like matters

whatsoever, that that presumption is deservedly to be held for certitude, as we taught above out of Innocent III. **We prie-** {marg. *C. Veniens de presbytero non baptizato.*} **-sts also all believe, without any hesitation, that we were ordained by the bishops who outwardly ordained us. And with the same certitude we believe that priests truly consecrate the Eucharist, as often as we assist at the sacrifice of the altar, although neither evidently nor by divine revelation is the intention established for us — whether of the ordaining bishop, or of the baptizing or consecrating priest — which we certainly know by faith to be necessary for the confecting of these sacraments. Nor is there anyone who would brand any man with the mark of rashness or of precipitancy on this account; nay, all judge it to be culpable, concerning any of these things, unless for causes of the greatest weight, even in the very least degree,**

{fol. 216v} {head: *ON THE UNCERTAINTY OF GRACE.*}

to hesitate. But that arguments as weighty can underlie the just, so that they believe {marg. *C*} themselves to be justified, as are those which make us believe for certain that both bishops and priests have, when they confect and confer these sacraments, the due inten- {marg. *Description*} -tion, we can make clear by a single example. He sees himself, Anto- [...]

[...]

NOTE — Expansions performed

All expansions below are silent in the text translated above. Types encountered in these pages:

Printed	Expanded as	Examples in these pages
vowel + macron (nasal suspension)	<i>n</i> or <i>m</i>	nō → non, quā → quam, eā → eam, unū → unum, quidē → quidem, euidēter → euidenter, contētis → contentis, fidē → fidem, Tridēto → Tridento, agnoscerēt → agnoscerent, Verū → Verum, Nā → Nam, cōsensu → consensu, cōmodissimum → commodissimum,

Printed	Expanded as	Examples in these pages
		Veniēs → Veniens, tantillulū → tantillulum, quenquā → quenquam, tamē → tamen
ī (i + macron)	<i>in</i>	ut & ī dogmatibus → <i>in dogmatibus</i> (fol. 5r)
oībus	omnibus	fol. 5r
		atq → atque, neq → neque, Itaq → Itaque, nunq → nunquam, minimeq → minimeque, cuiuscunq → cuiuscunque,
q / q; (q + tail)	<i>-que</i>	absq → absque, plærisq → plærisque, cælestemq → cælestemque, idemq → idemque, quæcunq → quæcunque
□ (q + macron/ stroke)	quod	Nam □ huic sessioni (fol. 4v)
q̄	quae	fol. 200v (twice): differentiā, q̄ est inter...; de fide, q̄ quidem...
q̄a	quia	fol. 200v: q̄a p̄ euidentiā...
p̄ (p with barred descender)	per	fol. 200v per euidentiam; fol. 206v certus esse per
.n.	enim	fol. 200v: Non.n. differt, De ratione.n. euidētiā
ʒ / □ (r-rotunda + stroke)	<i>-rum</i>	sanctoʒ → sanctorum (fol. 4v); earʒ → earum (fol. 200r)
0ēs	Omnes	fol. 5r
cōf. (in a marginal)	conf[essorum] — left unexpanded, see sic-note 22	fol. 211r

Expansion policy for $\bar{q}$ / $\bar{q}a$. The printer's own full forms alternate between $qu\bar{a}$ and $qu\bar{e}$ within these very pages, so the contraction supports neither. Abbreviated forms have been expanded with $\bar{a}$ ($qu\bar{a}$), because $qu\bar{a}$ is by a wide margin the printer's commoner full form in the roman fount used for the body text. Every instance is flagged in the sic-notes.

Not expanded. Marginal reference abbreviations (Deut.4.e, Prou.8., Ioan.14, Innoc. 3, Resp.1. ad argu.3.respon.3, Inno. albritius sum. cōf. li. 3. ti.22. q.8., Ange. uerbo. Bap.7, Veniens de pres. non bap.et.c. 1, Arg.7, d.17) are left exactly as printed, since they are citation formulae rather than contracted words.

SIC-NOTES, UNCERTAIN READINGS, IMAGE/OCR DISAGREEMENTS, DAMAGE

A. Printer's errors and anomalous forms (read from the image, retained in the text)

1. **fol. 4v** — Romanus Puntifex uicarius esse Christi — **Puntifex sic**, for *Pontifex*. Verified at 6× magnification; the *u* is unambiguous, no macron. The OCR layer reads the same. (Translated simply as “the Roman Pontiff”.)
2. **fol. 4v** — the chapter's opening sentence reads CIRCA authoritatem uero condentium hoc **derretum** aduertendum est... — **derretum sic**, for *decretum*. Verified at 7×; the double *r* is unmistakable. (This falls just outside the excerpt translated, but is recorded because it bears on the printer's accuracy in this forme.) The OCR layer reads the same.
3. **fol. 5r** — Cardinalis sante crucis — **sante sic**, for *sanctæ* (Marcello Cervini, Cardinal of Santa Croce in Gerusalemme). Verified at 6×; there is no abbreviation mark. Italianate form. (Englished as “Cardinal of Santa Croce”.)
4. **fol. 5r** — nempe uniuersalem ecclesiam representans and quin & uniuersalem Ecclesiam representauerit are printed **without $\bar{a}$ / $\bar{e}$** , while quod eam repræsentabat three lines earlier is printed **with $\bar{a}$** . All three verified. This is the clearest single instance of the printer's mixing; see convention 2. (The distinction is orthographic only and cannot be shown in English.)
5. **fol. 5r** — after Ecclesia Dei uno, and before eoque there is a small raised ink mark resembling an apostrophe or an inverted comma. It is almost

- certainly a stray ink speck or a broken sort, not a mark of punctuation; **not** transcribed, and so not represented in the translation. Flagged as uncertain.
6. **fol. 144v** — Veniens de præsbytero non baptizato — **præsbytero with æ**, whereas the same decretal is cited at fol. 216r marginal as de presbytero **without**. Both verified at 5–6×. Both forms are kept in Latin in the translation, so the alternation remains visible.
 7. **fol. 199v** — Nónne ante approbationem Ecclesie fides in phophetis — **phophetis sic**, for *prophetis* (dropped *r*). Verified at 2.2×; the word is unambiguous. Note that prophetas is spelled correctly nine lines above on the same page. (Translated as “the prophets”.)
 8. **fol. 199v** — quam expertis & demostratis — **demostratis sic**, for *demonstratis*. Verified at 8×: there is **no** macron over the *o*, so this is a genuine omission and not a contraction I have failed to expand. (Translated as “demonstrated”.)
 9. **fol. 200r** — Idenque patet de propositionibus — **Idenque sic**, for *Idemque*. Confirmed by the OCR layer. The same form recurs at fol. 216r (Idenque & de quibuscunque alijs), so it is a consistent house form rather than a one-off slip. (Translated as “The same is clear...” and “And the same we presume...”.)
 10. **fol. 200r** — Christus secundum corpus (line 6): the **r of Christus is badly under-inked /broken**, printing as a faint vertical stub, so the word images as Ch·istus. Verified at 8×. Read as Christus; recorded here as damage to the sort, not a variant reading.
 11. **fol. 200v** — & aliunde quam ex præmissis, habeat aliquos gradus — the printed spacing reads hab eat, with a wide space inside the word. Loose spacing only; read as habeat.
 12. **fol. 200v** — præmissis (with æ, line 9), præmissarum (with æ, line 18) and præmissis (with e, line 24) all occur **on the same page**. All three verified at 5–6×. (Orthographic only; not representable in English.)
 13. **fol. 211r** — ut communiter tradunt doctores thæologi — **thæologi sic**, for *theologi*. Verified at 6×; the æ ligature is unmistakable. The OCR layer reads the same. (Translated as “the doctors of theology”.)
 14. **fol. 216r** — Eadenque certitudine credimus — **Eadenque sic**, for *Eademque*. Verified at 6×; confirmed by the OCR layer. Cf. sic-note 9 (Idenque). (Translated as “And with the same certitude...”.)
 15. **fol. 144r** — ita magno & firmo consensu, ut certa habentur — printed habētur = *habentur*, where the syntax would expect *habeantur*. Rendered as printed (“are... held as certain”), not as the expected subjunctive.

B. Marginal rubrics — verifications and problems

1. **fol. 199v, the rubric requested for verification.** Reported to me as “*Certa est ex fide conclusio illata ex una credita et altera evidenti*”. The **printed text is**, set over six short lines: > Certa ē ex / fide, cōclu= / sio illata / ex una cre / dita et alte / ra euidēti.

i.e. expanded:

Certa est ex fide, conclusio illata ex una credita et altera euidenti. Verified at 3.5–4×. Two differences from the reported wording: (a) the printer has a **comma after fide**, and (b) euidenti is spelled with *u*, not *v*. Otherwise the reported wording is correct. Translated as “*The conclusion inferred from one premise believed and another evident is certain of faith.*”

2. **fol. 200v — Resp.1. ad argu.3.re-spon.3.** Printed over three lines as Reſp.1. ad / argu.3.re. / ſpon.3, i.e. the word *respon.* is broken across lines with a **full stop, not a hyphen**, at the break. Verified at 5–10×; the final character is unambiguously a **3**, not a 5 or a query. The OCR layer independently reads Resp. 1. ad argu. 3. re. spon. 3. The sense is presumably “*Resp[onsio] 1 ad argu[mentum] 3.æ respon[sionis]*” (Vega’s first reply to the argument advanced in support of the third *responsio* on fol. 199v), in which case the **final 3 is redundant or misplaced**. Reproduced exactly as printed except that *ad* is Englished as *to*; the reading is certain, the intended sense is not.

3. **fol. 5r — the Constance-title rubric is apparently corrupt as set.** Printed over eight short lines: > Cur nō est / adiectum / in titulo, l / uerbum i / lud Eccle= / siam uelē / > re præsen= / tans.

Read straight through this yields *Cur non est adiectum in titulo, l uerbum ilud Ecclesiam uelem repræsentans*, which does not construe. Two defects: (a) the **stray l at the end of line 3**, which belongs to no adjacent word (the next line begins *uerbum*), and (b) **uelē**, which I can make no sense of and which most plausibly represents a botched *uniuersalē* (*uniuersalem*) — the body text at this exact point reads *nempe uniuersalem ecclesiam representans*. The OCR layer, reading the same marginal, produces *Cur non est adiectum in titulo, uerbum illud Ecclesiam si am uelere præsents* — i.e. it silently drops the stray *l*, joins *i-lud* into *illud*, and likewise cannot resolve *uelē*. The marginal was transcribed as

printed, with the line-breaks marked by |, expanding only *nō* → *non* and *uelē* → *uelem*; in the translation the frame is Englished and the unconstruable words are left in Latin, with the | marks kept. The intended sense is certainly “*Why the phrase ‘Ecclesiam uniuersalem repraesentans’ was not added in the title*”. **This is the single least certain reading in the whole transcription.**

4. **fol. 200r — Argum. 4 has no final full stop**, whereas Argum. 2. and Argum. 3. on the same page do. Verified at 6× on an isolated crop of the margin; the space after the 4 is clean. The translated rubric Argument 4 likewise carries no full stop.
5. **fol. 200v — Euidencia summa alia est a non summa.** Printed over four lines (*Euidencia / summa alia / est a non / summa.*). The OCR layer garbles this, dropping *summa alia* from the third line and producing *Euidencia ... est a non summa.* The image reading is secure at 1.85×. Translated as “*Supreme evidence is other than non-supreme.*”
6. **fol. 211r — Inno. albritius sum. cōf. li.3. ti.22. q.8.** The second word is the problem. At 5× the letters are clearly *a-l-b-r-i / t-i-u-s* across the line break, giving **albritius**, and the OCR layer independently reads *albritius*. I can identify no canonist or summist of that name; likely candidates for what was intended (*Albericus*, *Albertus*) do not fit the letters. *sum. cōf.* is presumably *Summa Confessorum*, cited by book / title / question. **Left exactly as printed; the authority is unidentified.** The companion marginal *Ange. uerbo. Bap. 7* is certainly Angelus de Clavasio, *Summa Angelica*, s.v. *Baptismus* §7, and is secure.
7. **fol. 216r — C. Veniens de presbytero non baptizato.** Secure at 5×; note that the leading *C.* is the *capitulum* abbreviation and is distinct from the locus letters *A/B/C/D* used elsewhere in the margins. Left in Latin as a citation formula.
8. **fol. 144r — Gradus.2. fidei humanæ.** This is the rubric that marks the beginning of the **second grade** of human faith requested in Block B. It stands on the **recto** (fol. 144r = PDF 351), not on 144v, at the sentence *Secundum locum inter credibilia humana tenent...* The rubric standing on fol. 144v is *Gradus.3. fidei humanæ.*, which marks the **third** grade, at *Eodemque modo licet non æquali iure...*; it therefore also fixes the **end**

of the second grade at ...donec eidentissimis forsitan argumentis contrarium probaretur. Both rubrics verified at 2–2.4×. Translated as “*The 2nd grade of human faith.*” and “*The 3rd grade of human faith.*”

C. Image ⇌ OCR-layer disagreements (image is authoritative throughout)

1. **PDF 462 — the OCR layer is corrupt, as warned.** It reproduces only the first ten lines of the page, then repeats them **five times** with progressively scrambled marginal lists; it never reaches Respon. 2., Impugnatio, Respon. 3., Argum. 1. or any of the body text from Sed hæc satis in præsentia onward. **The whole of fol. 199v below line 10 is transcribed from the image alone, with no OCR cross-check available.** The OCR marginal lists for this page are also wrong: they give Respon. 3. twice and omit Certa ē ex fide... and Argum. 1. entirely.
2. **PDF 73 — folio number.** The OCR layer prints the running-head number as **9**. The image shows **5** unambiguously at 3×. The OCR is wrong; the rule 2n+63 requires 5.
3. **Systematic long-s / f confusion in the OCR layer.** Throughout these pages the OCR reads *f* as *s*: suit/suerint for fuit/fuerint, facrosancta for sacrosancta (the reverse error), sungi for fungi, impersecta/impersectio for imperfecta/imperfectio, mortiserum for mortiferum, secerint for fecerint. Each of the following was re-verified on the image at 6–8×, and the **image reading** is the one translated:
 - fol. 4v causa ****fuit**** diuturna quædam ægritudo (OCR suit) — “the cause was a certain long illness”;
 - fol. 144v hunc uel illum rite suo ****fungi**** ministerio (OCR sungi) — the *f* crossbar is plainly visible and contrasts with the long-s of suo two letters earlier — “that this or that man duly performs his ministry”;
 - fol. 200r certitudo scientiæ comparata ad certitudinem fidei ****imperfecta**** est and ****imperfectio**** est, & debilitas fidei (OCR impersecta, impersectio) — “is imperfect”, “is an imperfection”;
 - fol. 5r & expensa ****fuerunt**** ab omnibus Concilij patribus (OCR suerunt) — “was... weighed by all the Fathers of the Council”.
4. **fol. 144v line 1** — OCR & factum de eis dubitare; image & **fatuum de eis dubitare** (verified at 1.6×; *fatuum* is also what the sense requires —

- “they would think it stupid and foolish to doubt them”), and that is the reading translated.
5. **fol. 144v** — OCR *certam minimem dubiam fidem*; image **certam minimeque dubiam fidem** (minimeq, verified at 1.6×) — “a certain and in no way doubtful faith”.
 6. **fol. 144v** — OCR *Tameti enim hunc uel illum*; image **Tametsi enim...** — “For although...”.
 7. **fol. 4v** — OCR *non quoscuius*; image **non quosuis** (word divided quos - | uis across lines) — “not just anyone”.
 8. **fol. 199v** — OCR (in the surviving fragment) *quique **uere** diligit ipsum* without accent; the image has the **grave accent**, *uerè*. Similarly *quàm*, *palàm*, *Nónne* all carry printed accents that the OCR drops. Cf. fol. 216r *consecrare uerè Eucharistiam*, accent verified at 6×. (The accents are prosodic marks only and have no counterpart in the English.)
 9. **fol. 476 (206v)** — the OCR layer scrambles the left-margin authority stack, splitting and duplicating *Mag. sent. / Alex. Hal. / Gabr. / Maio.* and mis-transcribing & *alij.* as *Galij.* and 5. *Bona.* as *Bona..* None of these fall inside the excerpt translated, but they are recorded here as a caution against relying on the OCR for this page’s marginalia.
 10. **fol. 200v** — OCR *Verū hęc obiectio procedit ex praua intelligentia differē-tiæ*, agreeing with the image; but OCR renders the two *q̄* contractions as bare *q̄*, offering no guidance on the *æ/ę* question raised under “Expansion policy” above.

D. Physical condition of the leaves / scan artefacts

1. **PDF 72 (fol. 4v)** — the **lower right corner of the leaf is lifted/curled** in the scan, producing a wavy pale edge across roughly the bottom quarter of the image. No text is obscured; the last two lines (& *ex insulis fortunatis... / -cta ista Synodus ex benigna concessione...*) are fully legible.
2. **PDF 73 (fol. 5r)** — the **outer (right) edge of the leaf is torn or ragged** in the lower half of the scan, and the leaf is slightly cockled. The right-hand marginalia (*Diligentia adhibita conficiendo huic decreto.*) sit close to this edge but are complete. No loss of text.
3. **PDF 352 (fol. 144v)** — pronounced **show-through from the verso** across the whole text block, and a **manuscript annotation in a contemporary or slightly later hand** in the outer (left) margin, at the level of lines 1–6 and again lower down. The hand is faint and partly abraded; it appears to concern

- certitudo* and *baptismus*, but it is **not legible with confidence at this resolution and has not been transcribed**, and so is not represented in the translation. There is also an ink mark resembling + + or 4 4 immediately above the running head. All printed text is legible.
4. **PDF 351 (fol. 144r)** — heavy show-through and general greyness; the printed text remains legible, but readings from this page (used only for sic-note 23 and the lead-in sentence) are marginally less secure than those from the other leaves.
 5. **PDF 462, 463, 464, 476, 485, 495** — good, evenly inked impressions with only light show-through. The gutter side of 462 and 464 is slightly shadowed but no character is lost.
 6. **Bottom margins.** In lib. IX the type page ends roughly 300 px above the foot of the scanned leaf; the apparently “short” pages (462, 464, 476) are not truncated. Catchwords, where the printer supplies them, are set flush right on a line of their own below the last full line (verified for 464 *falsæ*, and 476 *fidem*,; folios 199v and 200r carry **no** catchword, so the practice is not consistent page-to-page in this book).

E. Residual uncertainties, ranked

- **High uncertainty** — the fol. 5r marginal rubric (sic-note 18): the stray *l* and the word *uelē*. I cannot resolve either; both are recorded as printed, and are left in Latin inside the Englished frame of the rubric.
- **Moderate uncertainty** — *albritius* at fol. 211r (sic-note 21): the letters are legible but the authority is unidentified, so I cannot use sense to confirm the reading.
- **Moderate uncertainty** — the trailing 3 of *Resp. 1. ad argu. 3. respon. 3* (sic-note 17): the glyph is certain, its function is not.
- **Low uncertainty** — the expansion of *q̄* as *quæ* rather than *quē* at fol. 200v (twice); an editorial choice, flagged rather than concealed. It has no effect on the English.
- **Low uncertainty** — sic-note 2 (*derretum*, fol. 4v), taken from outside the excerpt translated and checked only at low magnification.
- Everything else translated above rests on readings checked on the page image at between 1.6× and 10× magnification and reported with confidence.